INNOVATION DEPOT

Member Resource and Support Application

Milkman, Inc. (Mealvana Endurance)

April 2026

Prepared by Xuan Huang & Lee Martin

Company Foundations

Baseline information about your company and team

Company Name *

Milkman, Inc.

Founder Email *

xh.analytics@gmail.com, lee.b.martin@gmail.com

Year Founded *

2019

Website & Social Presence *

- Product website: https://endurance.mealvana.io/
- Company website: https://www.mealvana.io/
- LinkedIn (Xuan Huang, Founder): https://www.linkedin.com/in/xuan-huang/
- LinkedIn (Lee Martin, CTO): https://www.linkedin.com/in/lee-martin-developer
- Instagram: https://www.instagram.com/mealvana_endurance/
- App Store (iOS): https://apps.apple.com/us/app/mealvana-endurance/id6751113738
- Google Play: https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.milkman.mealvanaendurance&pli=1

Industry / Sector *

Sports Nutrition Technology / Health & Fitness

Company Stage *

Pre-revenue

Full-Time Team Size *

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Prior Funding *

We have not raised outside equity capital. Our external funding includes:

1. $25,000 Alabama Launchpad prize (November 2021) — Non-dilutive concept-stage prize from Alabama Launchpad Cycle 3 Finale, administered by the Economic Development Partnership of Alabama.
2. Innovation Depot Special Projects Grant (up to $9,750, December 2025 – April 2026) — Non-dilutive grant awarded by Innovation Depot to fund Dr. Rachel Mitchell (Ph.D. in Nutrition Science) at $100/hour for clinical validation of our nutrition algorithms, scientific QA of fueling recommendations, and creation of educational content (Mealvana 101 video series). Innovation Depot pays Dr. Mitchell directly on our behalf. This grant has been actively executed across two phases and has directly improved the scientific

rigor of our product.
3. Consulting revenue from Piggly Wiggly — Technology consulting engagement building and maintaining POS, sales, inventory, and accounting software systems for local Piggly Wiggly grocery stores in the Birmingham area. This work demonstrated our team's software development capabilities and generated revenue while building Mealvana. [CONFIRM: total amount and date range]

There are no outside equity investors, active advisors from prior funding, or board members. The cap table is clean — 100% founder-held. The company has been bootstrapped by the two co-founders since inception, supplemented by the non-dilutive grants and consulting revenue above.

Support Request

What you are trying to achieve, what is getting in the way, and which resources would help most

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Business Goals — Next 12 Months *

Our top three business goals for the next 12 months are:

1. Launch paid subscription and reach 100+ paying subscribers by Q1 2027. We have built the full product — AI-powered nutrition planning, coach mode, integrations with TrainingPeaks, FinalSurge, and Garmin — and are now implementing RevenueCat to gate 11 identified Pro features (training platform integrations, coach dashboard, brick workout planning, carb-loading protocols, personal templates, barcode scanning, and more). Our pricing target is $9.99/month or $69.99/year with a 1-month free trial.

2. Grow to 1,000+ app downloads and onboard 10+ coaches to Coach Mode. Coach Mode v2 is production-ready with many-to-many coach-athlete relationships, email invitations, permission levels, messaging, and a web-based dashboard. We need to drive initial adoption among RRCA-certified running coaches and sports dietitians to validate the B2B revenue channel (targeting $20-$50/month per coach subscription).

3. Close a pre-seed round of $250K-$500K within 3-6 months to fund a go-to-market hire, extend runway, and accelerate user acquisition. This fundraise will be our first outside capital beyond the Alabama Launchpad prize.

Core Problem / Constraint *

Capital and runway. We are a two-person founding team that has bootstrapped a production-grade, feature-rich product — but we are resource-constrained on two fronts that capital would unlock:

First, we lack dedicated go-to-market capacity. Both founders are spending the majority of their time on product development, which means user acquisition, content marketing, coach outreach, and partnership development receive insufficient attention. We need either a dedicated hire or funded marketing initiatives to drive the top of the funnel.

Second, our runway limits how aggressively we can pursue the revenue milestones that would make us investable. We have a live product with 100-500 users, positive beta feedback, coach interest, and a clear monetization path — but converting that into paying subscribers and closing enterprise pilot deals requires sustained effort that our current bandwidth cannot support.

The constraint is not product or technology — it is the resources to bring what we have already built to market effectively.

How You Will Measure Success *

Over the next 12 months, we will track:

- App installs: Target 1,000+ total downloads across iOS and Android (currently 100-500 users)
- Paid conversion: Target 100+ paying subscribers at $9.99/month or $69.99/year, representing ~$12K-$70K ARR depending on mix
- Coach Mode adoption: Target 10+ verified coaches onboarded, each managing 5-10 athletes, as validation for the B2B revenue channel
- Fundraise: Close a $250K-$500K pre-seed round within 3-6 months
- Retention: Establish baseline retention metrics via Mixpanel (we have analytics infrastructure in place but are still building a meaningful data set)
- Coach Mode MRR: Reach $1K-$2K MRR from coach subscriptions within 6 months of launch

"Winning" by Q1 2027 means: subscription revenue live, 100+ paying users demonstrating willingness to pay, a closed pre-seed round, and 10+ coaches actively using the platform — proving both B2C and B2B product-market fit.

Works in Progress *

Yes, we are actively working on the capital constraint:

What we have tried:

- Successfully applied for and received an Innovation Depot Special Projects Grant, which funded Dr. Rachel Mitchell (sports dietitian) for clinical validation of our nutrition algorithms — this directly improved the scientific rigor of our product
- Generated consulting revenue through a project with Piggly Wiggly, demonstrating our team's ability to deliver value in adjacent nutrition/data spaces while building Mealvana
- Won the $25K Alabama Launchpad prize (2021) for concept validation
- Maintained extremely lean operations — two full-time co-founders, supplemented by a part-time user researcher (Rui Tian), a part-time sports dietitian (Dr. Rachel Mitchell), and an engineering consultant

(Haibin Zhuang)
- Continued aggressive bootstrapping: shipped 18 app versions, built Coach Mode, completed integrations with TrainingPeaks, FinalSurge, and Garmin, and built a web portal — all on personal capital

What we learned:
- The product is strong enough to attract organic users and positive feedback, but without dedicated marketing and sales bandwidth, growth is linear rather than exponential
- Coach interest is real but requires active outreach and relationship-building that is difficult to sustain alongside full-time product development
- The monetization infrastructure (RevenueCat) is near-complete, which means the gap between "built" and "generating revenue" is primarily a go-to-market execution problem, not a product problem

We have not yet pitched investors because we want to have subscription revenue live and initial paying customers before entering fundraise conversations — which is why the grant and capital readiness support from Innovation Depot is timely.

Support Priorities

Rate how much you need each type of support right now

The Network — Priority Rating *
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The Network — Details *

We'd benefit most from expert matching on three specific challenges:

1. Co-founder performance coaching. Innovation Depot has flagged that our team is building too slowly, and we agree this is the right concern to address head-on. The root cause isn't capacity — it's that our cofounders are operating as peers without a built-in tiebreaker structure. We've developed differing views on our ideal customer profile and product direction, and the cycles spent re-litigating these disagreements are slowing execution. A performance coach experienced in co-founder dynamics would help us align on strategic direction, develop better disagreement-resolution patterns, and unlock the decision-making bottlenecks that are showing up as build velocity. This is the highest-leverage Network ask we can name — addressing it accelerates everything else.

2. B2B2C distribution through coaching channels. Mealvana Endurance's primary channel is endurance coaches, who onboard their athletes onto our platform. We have meaningful coach interest (60+ coaches engaged through Endurance Exchange and the B.E.S.T. annual meeting), but converting interest into paying customers and scaling beyond founder-led outreach is the open question. Expert input from someone who's built a coach- or practitioner-mediated SaaS distribution model — particularly in fitness, nutrition, or adjacent verticals — would help us structure paid coach pilots, design conversion incentives, and build a repeatable acquisition motion.

3. Consumer subscription unit economics for endurance/fitness apps. We are about to test three direct-to-athlete acquisition channels (race partnerships, paid ads, influencer marketing) with grant funding. Our planning assumes a 5% install-to-paid conversion rate as a "high-performing app" benchmark, but we have not yet measured Mealvana's actual rate. An advisor with experience optimizing freemium funnels and CAC/LTV economics for fitness or health subscription apps would help us instrument the right metrics, set realistic kill criteria, and avoid burning grant budget on a leaky funnel.

Special Projects Grant — Priority Rating *

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Special Projects Grant — Details *

We are requesting Special Projects Grant support for a structured 16–20 week test of two direct-to-athlete acquisition channels for Mealvana Endurance.

The initiative. We are now testing direct-to-athlete acquisition as a complementary channel: not to replace coach-led distribution, but to bring the product to market at a faster speed and help us to achieve our 12-month goal.

The two channels and their named vendors:

1. **Paid digital advertising ($5K - 10K).** Multi-channel test across Meta (Instagram Reels), Reddit (r/running, r/triathlon, r/AdvancedRunning), and Google Search. Phase 1 validates two channels in parallel ($3K); Phase 2 concentrates spend on the winner ($5K); Phase 3 commits or kills ($2K). Vendor: Uptick Marketing (Birmingham-based agencies with paid social specialty), or self-managed direct platform spend. Detailed plan: https://www.notion.so/Paid-ad-spend-metrics-34fe3fdb754c80bc9e48fbdbe1ffed95?source=copy_link
2. **Influencer marketing ($5k - 8K).** Paid partnerships with 1–2 endurance-niche creators (target: 30K–100K followers, real competitive credentials, no competing nutrition business). Phase 1 validates with 2 creators in the micro-lower tier ($2K); Phase 2 scales the winning profile ($4K); Phase 3 commits or kills ($2K). Vendor: BibRave (national endurance influencer specialist) or Sociallyin for managed campaigns; alternatively

direct-to-creator partnerships. Detailed plan: https://www.notion.so/Influencer-metrics-34fe3fdb754c80368145d90615eaf873?source=copy_link

The measurable result we commit to in advance. By Week 20, we deliver: (a) measured cost per install, free-to-paid conversion rate, and effective customer acquisition cost for each of the three channels; (b) a documented playbook for the lowest-CAC channel. Target: at least one channel achieving CAC under $100 with a documented path to scale.

Why this initiative, why now. Distribution through coaches is cheap, but also very manual – cold email -> book a call -> interview & onboarding. D2C distribution is easy to scale and will increase our top funnel immensely. Our bottleneck is to identify which D2C funnel generates the highest ROI (lowest CAC) and this funding will help us achieve that. The app has been in development for 9 months, in the next 3 months we will bring it to completion and have a paywall set up. By that time, we will have a more accurate reading on trial -> paying user conversion rate. If that rate is high (> 5%), the economics will work for many of these channels.

Capital Readiness — Priority Rating *

3

Capital Readiness — Details *

Round: Pre-seed / pre-priced bridge on a SAFE.

Target size: $250K–$500K.

Valuation: TBD — likely a SAFE with valuation cap rather than a priced round, given the size and stage. Cap target informed by comparables once we develop materials.

Timeline: Active raise targeted for late 2026, with conversations with warm investors potentially earlier. We want to deploy the Special Projects Grant–funded channel tests first, so we go to market with measured CAC data and signed race partnership rather than projections alone.

Where we are now: Starting from scratch on materials. We have a MVP version of fundraising deck, financial model, and data roomt. We have meaningful underlying substance to draw from — coach interview database, shipped product with detailed roadmap, competitive intelligence on MyFitnessPal and Fuelin, and a clear B2B2C thesis with Mealvana Endurance as the beachhead in a longer roadmap toward general consumer meal planning and B2B grocery curation. But none of this is yet packaged for investors. We are yet to generate revenue but we expect to see revenue by the end of the summer (July).

With the support of the grant, we will also have a playbook of go-to-market strategy to scale the distribution.

Where we'd most benefit from structured support:

1. **Pitch narrative.** Clarifying the story across three layers — Mealvana Endurance as the immediate product, Mealvana as the consumer meal-planning roadmap, and Milkman Inc. as the broader B2B grocery vision. Investors at this stage need to understand the beachhead-to-platform progression without losing focus on near-term execution.
2. **Investor targeting.** Identifying the right investor profile — fitness/health tech specialists, consumer subscription investors, food/grocery tech investors, Southeast regional capital — and prioritizing warm-intro paths.
3. **Financial model and milestones.** Building the underlying model with credible revenue projections, especially around coach-channel unit economics and the still-being-measured B2C funnel conversion rates.
4. **Diligence prep.** Anticipating the questions sharper investors will ask: B2B2C distribution defensibility, competitive positioning vs. Fuelin and MAVR, founder dilution and cap-table state given Milkman Inc. parent structure, and the long-term roadmap risk (endurance niche → general consumer → B2B grocery is a non-trivial leap).

Pilot Program — Priority Rating *

5

Pilot Program — Details *

Ideal pilot scenarios. We are scoping two complementary race nutrition escort partnerships with regional Southeast race organizers. In both cases, Mealvana provides free Pro accounts as a registrant or member perk during the race build; the race partner promotes the perk through registrant communications and includes us as a race partner with booth presence at events.

Pilot 1 (primary): Magic Sports / Team Magic — Birmingham-rooted multi-event Southeast triathlon and running series, run by Therese Bynum (UAB-educated) and Faye Yates. 10+ events annually across TN, AL, KY (~5,000–8,000 unique participants), including USAT regional and national championship events. Magic Sports already has a coach partnership with Tom Regal of TriTomR Endurance — nutrition is the natural complement. They operate an existing paid membership program (Team Magic) which gives us a clean integration point for adding Mealvana Pro as a member benefit, creating a recurring B2B value exchange beyond per-event sponsorship. Anchor events for Year 1: Buster Britton (Pelham/Birmingham, must-have given Birmingham angle), Chattanooga Waterfront Triathlon (their flagship), and 1–2 additional events selected with their team.

Pilot 2: Huntsville Track Club / Rocket City Marathon — 50th anniversary in December 2026, growing race targeting 7,000 participants. Existing relationship from prior Mealvana expo presence and unpaid newsletter inclusions. The 50th anniversary creates a one-time elevated marketing moment. Smaller, single-event scope than Magic Sports — but a complementary test of how the escort partnership shape works for a marathon (running) audience vs. Magic Sports' triathlon focus.

Why both, not one. Running and triathlon registrants are different ICPs with different nutrition behaviors. Testing both lets us measure whether the escort partnership shape works across endurance verticals or only in one. Rocket City also provides an in-state Alabama proof point that complements Magic Sports' Birmingham roots — together they reinforce Innovation Depot's regional mandate.

Path to commercial relationship.

- **Magic Sports**: Year 1 escort partnership converts to a renewable annual partnership in 2027 with deeper member-program integration and potential revenue-sharing on athlete-side conversions. Their multi-event structure means the pilot itself is a multi-touchpoint commercial relationship, not a single transaction.
- **Rocket City**: Successful 2026 pilot converts to renewable annual partnership at modestly higher tier in 2027, anchored on a continuing 50-years-and-beyond narrative.
- **Replication template**: Both pilots together establish a template we adapt for additional regional race partners — Mercedes Marathon (Birmingham), Birmingham Track Club events, Vulcan Run, and similar regional series across AL/TN/GA/FL. Each replicated partnership reduces sales cycle and CAC compared to ground-zero outreach.

Where we'd most benefit from Pilot Program support.

1. **Partnership scoping for Magic Sports specifically.** This is the more complex of the two — multi-event scope, member-program integration, coordination with the existing Tom Regal coach partnership. Help structuring the agreement so the pilot has a clean conversion path to a deeper 2027 commercial relationship.
2. **Negotiating registrant-promotion commitments.** The single most important variable for activation rate is how often and how visibly each race partner promotes the perk to registrants. Pilot Program's commercial-process expertise would help us negotiate these commitments into the agreement itself rather than leaving them implicit.
3. **Replication template documentation.** Documenting both pilots as a repeatable template — turning two pilots into a pipeline of regional race partnerships across the Southeast.

Business & Market

The opportunity you are building into and the strength of your model

Problem You Are Solving *

Endurance athletes — runners, cyclists, and triathletes preparing for races from 5K to ultra-marathons — face a critical and underserved nutrition planning problem: they don't know what to eat, when to eat it, or how much to consume before, during, and after training and races.

The cost of getting this wrong is significant:
- GI distress during races (30-50% of marathon runners report it, per published ACSM data) caused by untested foods, improper timing, or excessive intake
- Bonking / hitting the wall from insufficient carbohydrate fueling, which degrades performance by 10-20% in the final miles
- Poor recovery that extends downtime between training sessions, increasing injury risk
- Wasted money on race entry fees ($100-$300+ per marathon), travel, and months of training undermined by a nutrition mistake on race day

Today, athletes cobble together nutrition plans from generic blog posts, word-of-mouth, or trial-and-error. Coaches who want to provide nutrition guidance do so manually via spreadsheets and PDFs — time-consuming, inconsistent, and not personalized to the individual athlete's biometrics, food preferences, allergies, or gut tolerance.

Mealvana Endurance solves this by generating personalized, science-based nutrition plans using ACSM metabolic formulas and ISSN sports nutrition guidelines, tailored to each athlete's body weight, pace, distance, dietary preferences, food allergies, gut training level, and even race-day weather conditions. We provide phase-specific guidance (pre-workout, during-workout, and recovery), recommend specific foods the athlete actually likes, and adjust hydration and sodium targets based on temperature and humidity.

For coaches and sports dietitians, our Coach Mode eliminates manual nutrition planning entirely — they connect with athletes digitally, monitor and edit nutrition plans via a web dashboard, and deliver personalized guidance at scale.

Market Size (TAM / SAM / SOM) *

TAM (Total Addressable Market): $4.2B
The global sports nutrition market was valued at $45.2B in 2024 (Grand View Research), growing at 7.5% CAGR. Within this, the digital sports nutrition and fitness app segment represents approximately $4.2B, encompassing nutrition tracking, meal planning, and coaching platforms used by endurance and fitness athletes worldwide.

SAM (Serviceable Addressable Market): $680M
We focus specifically on endurance athletes (runners, cyclists, triathletes) in English-speaking markets (US, UK, Canada, Australia). There are approximately 60 million active runners in the US alone (Running USA), 47 million cyclists, and 4.4 million triathlon participants. Our SAM is the subset who race competitively or train for organized events — approximately 17 million in the US — and would pay for a

specialized nutrition planning tool. At an average of $40/year (blended between casual and committed subscribers), this represents ~$680M.

SOM (Serviceable Obtainable Market): $2M-$5M in 5 years
Our realistic 5-year capture target is 10,000-25,000 paying subscribers across B2C ($70/year) and B2B coach subscriptions ($240-$600/year per coach). Bottom-up: if we reach 5,000 individual subscribers ($350K ARR) and 200 coaches averaging 15 athletes each ($120K ARR from coach subscriptions), we reach $470K ARR in year 3 and $2M-$5M by year 5 through geographic expansion and deeper integration partnerships.

Methodology: Bottom-up from race registration data (RunSignUp reports 10M+ US race registrations/year), training platform user bases (TrainingPeaks: 1M+ users; Strava: 120M+ users; FinalSurge: growing), and comparable health/fitness app conversion rates (1-3% free-to-paid).

Market Trends & Timing *

Several converging trends make this the right time:

1. Endurance sports participation is at record levels. Post-COVID, marathon finishers in the US rebounded to 650,000+ in 2023 (Running USA), and half-marathon participation exceeded 2 million. Triathlon participation is growing 8-10% annually. More participants means more demand for nutrition guidance.

2. AI is transforming personalized health. The consumer expectation for AI-driven personalization has shifted dramatically in 2024-2026 — from generic recommendations to individually tailored plans. We ride this wave by using LLMs and linear programming to generate nutrition plans that are both scientifically rigorous and personally relevant.

3. Endurance coaching is professionalizing and going digital. Platforms like TrainingPeaks, TrainerRoad, and FinalSurge have digitized training plans. Nutrition is the last major pillar of endurance performance that remains manual and fragmented. Our TrainingPeaks, FinalSurge, and Garmin integrations position us as the nutrition layer that complements existing training platforms.

4. Sports nutrition product market is booming. The gels, bars, and hydration product market continues to grow with new brands entering constantly. These brands need data-driven channels to reach endurance athletes — our product recommendation engine creates a potential marketplace/affiliate revenue stream.

5. Coach economy is expanding. More coaches are building independent practices and need digital tools to serve clients at scale. The shift to remote coaching (accelerated by COVID) means coaches need digital platforms for nutrition guidance, not in-person meal prep sessions.

Competitive Landscape *

Direct competitors:

- Fuelin (fuelin.com): The closest competitor — AI-powered daily nutrition recommendations for endurance athletes, integrated with TrainingPeaks and Garmin. Strengths: established brand, pro athlete endorsements (used by Ironman athletes). Weaknesses: focused primarily on daily macros rather than race-specific fueling plans, higher price point (~$15/month), no coach mode, limited food preference personalization. We differentiate with deeper race-day specificity (phase-by-phase, hour-by-hour fueling plans), food preference learning, and our Coach Mode for B2B.

- Precision Fuel & Hydration (precisionfuelandhydration.com): Sweat testing and hydration planning for endurance athletes. Strengths: strong brand, partnerships with pro teams, product sales revenue. Weaknesses: primarily a product company (selling electrolytes) with a planning tool as a lead-gen feature, not a comprehensive nutrition planning platform. We compete on breadth — full pre/during/post nutrition plans, not just hydration.

- Hexis (hexisperformance.com): AI daily nutrition planner for athletes. Strengths: clean UX, periodized nutrition. Weaknesses: broader athlete focus (not endurance-specific), newer to market, limited integrations.

Indirect competitors:

- MyFitnessPal / Cronometer: General calorie and macro tracking apps. Not endurance-specific, no race fueling plans, no AI-generated recommendations tailored to activity parameters. We do not compete on daily food logging — we solve the race-day and training-day fueling problem specifically.

- TrainingPeaks / Strava: Training platforms, not nutrition platforms. They are integration partners, not competitors. Neither offers nutrition plan generation.

Our sustainable competitive advantages:
1. Dual AI + algorithmic system: Our LLM-powered planning with deterministic fallback ensures both quality and reliability — no competitor offers this hybrid approach
2. Food preference learning: Three-tier preference system (love/willing-to-try/avoid) that personalizes recommendations in a way no competitor matches
3. Coach Mode (B2B): Built-in many-to-many coaching platform with web dashboard — Fuelin and Hexis have no equivalent
4. Integration depth: Live integrations with TrainingPeaks, FinalSurge, and Garmin. Our TrainingPeaks write-back (pushing nutrition data back to the training platform) is unique
5. Offline-first architecture: Full functionality without internet — critical for athletes in remote training locations
6. Evidence-based foundation: Built on validated ACSM metabolic formulas and ISSN guidelines, not generic nutrition advice

We acknowledge that Fuelin has a head start on brand awareness and athlete endorsements. Our advantage is product depth, coach integration, and the ability to serve both individual athletes and coaching organizations as a platform.

Business Model *

Dual revenue model: B2C subscriptions + B2B coach subscriptions.

B2C (Individual Athletes):
- Free tier: Basic nutrition plan generation, food preference tracking, gut training guidance
- Pro tier: $9.99/month or $69.99/year (1-month free trial)
- Pro features: Training platform integrations (TrainingPeaks, FinalSurge, Garmin write-back), Coach Mode access, brick workout nutrition, personal fueling templates, Mealvana 101 video course, by-hour race-day planning, food journaling, barcode scanning, carb-loading protocols, adaptive macro adjustment
- Payment: RevenueCat (in-app subscriptions via Apple/Google)

B2B (Coaches & Dietitians):
- Free during beta (current phase)
- Starter: $20/month (up to 20 athletes)
- Pro: $50/month (unlimited athletes, advanced analytics)
- Payment: Stripe (planned)
- Sales motion: Direct outreach to RRCA, USAT, ACE, NASM, ACSM-certified coaches; partnerships with coaching organizations; content marketing targeting coaches

Future revenue streams (12-24 month horizon):
- Product placement / affiliate revenue from sports nutrition brands featured in recommendations
- Enterprise partnerships with race event organizers (bulk athlete access)
- API licensing for training platforms seeking a nutrition intelligence layer

Revenue & Traction *

We are currently pre-revenue. Our most significant traction signals:

- 100-500 app users across iOS and Android with organic discovery (no paid acquisition to date)
- Endurance Exchange 2026 (Jan 9-11): Exhibited at the largest endurance coaching conference — 61 coaches and race directors visited our booth, resulting in a pipeline of 40+ qualified coach contacts now in our CRM
- Final Surge partnership discussions: Advanced conversations with CEO Tim Surface about deeper integration beyond our existing API connection. Final Surge is a leading endurance training platform and a potential distribution channel.
- 18 product versions shipped (v1.0 through v1.18.1) since launch, demonstrating rapid iteration and product maturity
- 20+ user interviews conducted with athletes, coaches, and dietitians, directly informing product

development and validating pain points
- App Store public launch at the Rocket City Marathon (December 12, 2025) — our first major in-person distribution event
- Active podcast in production, driving awareness with both coaches and athletes
- Production-ready Coach Mode v2 with web dashboard, ready for onboarding
- Live integrations with TrainingPeaks (credentials approved December 2025), FinalSurge, and Garmin
- Innovation Depot Special Projects Grant (up to $9,750) actively funding Dr. Rachel Mitchell for scientific QA and educational content creation
- Mixpanel analytics active and tracking user behavior, establishing baseline engagement data
- $25,000 Alabama Launchpad prize (2021) as external validation of concept and team
- Full monetization infrastructure nearly complete (RevenueCat implementation in progress, Pro features identified and gated)

We expect to have subscription revenue live within 60 days of this application.

Regulatory Environment

Our market is not heavily regulated. Mealvana Endurance provides nutrition planning guidance, not medical advice, and we make this distinction explicit in our Terms of Service and in-app disclaimers. Key considerations:

- We do not diagnose, treat, or prescribe — our plans are informational and evidence-based, similar to content from running magazines or coaching websites
- Our Coach Mode verifies professional certifications (RRCA, USAT, ACE, NASM, ACSM) and professional liability insurance, which demonstrates responsible platform design
- App Store health claims policies require careful language — we frame our science-based recommendations as "guidance" rather than "treatment"
- We collect minimal personal data (device-based authentication is default, no user accounts required) and are transparent about data practices in our privacy policy
- Dr. Rachel Mitchell, our part-time sports dietitian, reviews nutrition algorithm outputs for clinical appropriateness

Team & Founder

Who you are, what makes you uniquely positioned, and how you lead

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Founder Background *

Xuan Huang — CEO & Co-founder
Xuan is a statistician by training and an engineer at heart. Her background in data science and analytics is

the foundation of Mealvana's personalized nutrition algorithms. She personally experienced the meal planning problem — first as a busy professional trying to answer "what's for dinner?" (which inspired the original Mealvana consumer app) and then watching endurance athlete friends struggle with race nutrition. Before Milkman, she built data products in professional settings and has deep expertise in statistical modeling, machine learning, and recommendation systems. She has prior startup experience and has built industry connections in the Birmingham startup ecosystem through Innovation Depot, Forge, and Alabama Launchpad.

Lee Martin — CTO & Co-founder
Lee is a full-stack engineer and Ironman triathlete (Ironman Florida 2025, 11:40 finish) whose personal experience with race nutrition directly shaped the product. He has extensive experience in Flutter mobile development, Supabase backend architecture, and AI/ML integration. His meticulous approach to design and user experience — combined with firsthand understanding of what endurance athletes need during training and races — makes him uniquely positioned to build the technical product. Lee architected the dual AI + algorithmic nutrition planning system, the offline-first architecture, and the Coach Mode web portal.

Together, Xuan and Lee combine data science rigor with engineering execution and genuine domain expertise as athletes and food enthusiasts. They are supported by Dr. Rachel Mitchell (sports dietitian providing clinical validation), Rui Tian (user researcher), and Haibin Zhuang (engineering consultant).

LinkedIn Profiles *

- Xuan Huang (Founder/CEO): https://www.linkedin.com/in/xuan-huang/
- Lee Martin (CTO): https://www.linkedin.com/in/lee-martin-developer

Team & Next Hire *

Current core team:
- Xuan Huang — CEO & Co-founder (full-time). Strategy, data science, business development, product direction
- Lee Martin — CTO & Co-founder (full-time). Engineering, architecture, product development, design
- Dr. Rachel Mitchell — Sports Dietitian (part-time). Clinical validation of nutrition algorithms, Mealvana 101 educational content
- Rui Tian — User Researcher (part-time). User interviews, feedback synthesis, UX research
- Haibin Zhuang — Engineering Consultant. Backend infrastructure and scalability

Next hire: Head of Growth / Sales & Partnerships

This is our most critical gap. Both founders are deep in product — which has produced a robust, feature-rich app — but we need a dedicated person driving user acquisition, coach outreach, and partnership development. The ideal hire is someone with experience in health/fitness app marketing, B2B SaaS sales (specifically selling to coaches or fitness professionals), and endurance sports community connections. This hire directly addresses our core constraint: converting a strong product into revenue requires dedicated go-to-market execution, not more engineering.

Long-Term Vision *

Build to scale

Long-Term Vision — Explanation *

Our long-term vision is to become the nutrition intelligence layer for the entire endurance sports ecosystem.

Today, training platforms (TrainingPeaks, Strava, Garmin) tell athletes *how* to train. Mealvana tells them *how to fuel*. We believe nutrition planning will become as essential and integrated as training plans — and that the company that owns the intelligent, personalized nutrition data layer will capture significant value.

The endgame in milestones:

1. Near-term (12 months): Prove B2C and B2B product-market fit with paying subscribers and active coaches. Close pre-seed round.

2. Mid-term (2-3 years): Expand integrations to become the default nutrition engine within the major training platforms (TrainingPeaks, Strava, Garmin, Wahoo). Build a product recommendation marketplace where nutrition brands pay for intelligent placement in athlete fueling plans. Reach $2M+ ARR.

3. Long-term (5+ years): Become the platform where every endurance athlete gets their personalized nutrition plan — whether directly through our app, through their coach, through their training platform, or through their race event. Expand from endurance sports into broader sports nutrition (team sports, strength athletes, recreational fitness). License our nutrition intelligence engine to enterprise partners (hospital wellness programs, corporate fitness, military performance optimization).

4. Scale milestone: 100,000+ athletes using Mealvana-powered nutrition plans (directly or through partners), generating $10M+ ARR through a mix of consumer subscriptions, coach/enterprise subscriptions, and marketplace/API revenue.

We are building a standalone, venture-scale nutrition technology company — not a lifestyle business. The endurance sports market is large enough and underserved enough in nutrition specifically to support this trajectory, and our technical architecture (AI + evidence-based algorithms + offline-first + coach platform + integration layer) is purpose-built for platform scale.

Product & Brand

Where your product and brand stand today — and where they are headed

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Product Demo *

[Upload your Loom video — 5-10 minutes walking through the app: onboarding, plan generation, food preferences, Coach Mode, integrations, carb loading]

Product Roadmap *

Our top 3 product priorities for the next 6-12 months:

1. Subscription monetization via RevenueCat (Q2 2026)
   - *What*: Launch the paid Pro tier ($9.99/month, $69.99/year) gating 11 premium features behind a paywall
   - *Why*: Beta user feedback confirms willingness to pay for training platform integrations, coach access, and advanced fueling tools. We cannot sustain development on bootstrapped capital alone. Every conversation with potential investors starts with "do you have revenue?" — this is the prerequisite for our fundraise.
   - *Driving signal*: Multiple beta users have asked when paid features will be available; coach interest is contingent on a sustainable business model behind the platform.

2. Coach Mode go-to-market and onboarding optimization (Q2-Q3 2026)
   - *What*: Streamline coach registration, automate certification verification (currently manual), build coach-facing marketing materials, and onboard first 10+ paying coaches
   - *Why*: Coach Mode v2 is production-ready but untested at scale. User research (Rui Tian) indicates coaches want a nutrition tool that integrates with their existing workflow. The B2B channel has higher LTV per customer and provides a built-in distribution mechanism (each coach brings 10-50 athletes).
   - *Driving signal*: Direct conversations with RRCA-certified coaches who currently deliver nutrition guidance via manually created PDFs and spreadsheets.

3. Deeper Garmin and wearable data integration (Q3-Q4 2026)
   - *What*: Use Garmin push data (heart rate, sleep, stress, body composition) to auto-adjust nutrition recommendations based on recovery status, training load, and biometric trends
   - *Why*: The integration infrastructure is built (Garmin push endpoints live, edge functions deployed), but we are currently only matching completed activities to planned ones. Closing the loop — using wearable data to personalize nutrition proactively — is a significant competitive differentiator that no competitor currently offers.
   - *Driving signal*: Beta user requests for "smarter" recommendations that account for how they slept, their HRV, and their training load trends.

Intellectual Property

We have filed trademarks for "Milkman" and "Mealvana." Our primary proprietary technology includes:

- Dual AI + algorithmic nutrition planning engine: A hybrid system combining LLM-powered planning with a deterministic fallback algorithm using ACSM metabolic formulas, ISSN guidelines, and linear programming optimization. This dual-system approach (AI-first with algorithmic reliability guarantee) is architecturally unique in the sports nutrition space.
- Food preference learning system: A three-tier preference model (love/willing-to-try/avoid) with phase-specific food scoring that personalizes recommendations while maintaining nutritional targets — a proprietary approach to balancing athlete preferences with science-based requirements.
- "Fat backend" content management system: A server-side architecture that allows nutrition algorithm parameters, food databases, and UI content to be updated without app store releases — enabling rapid A/B testing and continuous improvement of nutrition recommendations.

We are evaluating whether to file a provisional patent on the dual-system nutrition planning methodology.

Customer Validation *

Our best validation evidence:

- Endurance Exchange 2026 (the largest endurance coaching conference): 61 coaches and race directors visited our booth over 3 days. We ran an interactive mood board exercise that surfaced key pain points: coaches want educational and communication tools to guide athletes on nutrition without spending hours explaining the basics. This directly validated our Coach Mode value proposition. 40+ qualified contacts are now in our CRM with active follow-up.
- 100-500 organic users with zero paid acquisition spend — all growth through word-of-mouth and organic app store discovery, indicating genuine demand
- 20+ structured user interviews with athletes, coaches, and dietitians, conducted by our user researcher (Rui Tian), directly informing product roadmap decisions
- Final Surge CEO relationship: Tim Surface (CEO of Final Surge, a leading endurance training platform) is in advanced partnership discussions with us — exploring deeper integration beyond our existing API connection
- Dr. Rachel Mitchell (Ph.D. Nutrition Science) joined as paid advisor after seeing the product — a strong validation signal. Innovation Depot funded this engagement through a Special Projects Grant.
- Positive beta feedback driving product development: users specifically requested and validated carb loading protocols, food preference learning, and Coach Mode — features we built in direct response to user input
- 18 shipped versions incorporating user feedback, demonstrating product-market dialogue (not just building in a vacuum)
- TrainingPeaks credential approval (December 2025): TrainingPeaks reviewed our product and granted API access with broad scopes (athlete profile, events, nutrition, workouts, metrics, webhooks) — third-party platform validation of our product's quality and value proposition

- Alabama Launchpad prize ($25K, 2021): External panel of judges and investors validated the concept and team at the competition stage

Pitch Deck *

[Upload your latest pitch deck here]

Additional Materials

[Upload any one-pagers, press coverage, or supporting materials]

Submission Date *

04/08/2026